

MISSION MILLET MANTRA FOR HEALTH AND PROSPERITY

During the separate state movement in Uttarakhand the slogan of "Mandua Jhangora Khayenge... Uttarakhand Rajya Banayenge" was very popular. The slogan itself prooves that millets particularly Mandua and Jhangora have very special status in the life of people of the state.

Today the world is recognising these millets as super food but long before this happened, the millets were a part of staple food in the daily life of people of Uttarakhand.

That is the reason when the central government decided to promote the millets and made specific allocation in the current budget and also expected the states to work in this field, then within 2 weeks of the presentation of the union budget, the Uttarakhand government launched mission millets scheme. In this scheme 73 crore rupees has been allocated for promotion of marketing and production of Mandua in state. Out of these 73 crore rupees 53 crore rupees will be given to agriculture department and 20 crore to the cooperative society for this purpose.

United Nations has announced year 2023 as international year of millets.

The Uttarakhand government had sent a proposal to the Union Food and Public Distribution Department to procure Mandua for the crop year 2022-23, which had been approved by the central government.

After this the farmers will get better price of Mandua. State government has also decided that it will purchase Mandua from farmers through mandi and cooperatives. This will encourage the farmers for the production of Mandua. Under the scheme the Mandua will be purchased from farmers through cooperative societies at the rate of 35.74 rupees per kg. Along with it another millet of Uttarakhand, This will also encourage the millet farmers in hilly districts.

After the purchase, the Mandua will be distributed through PDS system, anganwadi and mid meal scheme. The bread of Mandua will be given to childern in mid day meal and Jhangora will also be given in the mid day meal.

Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami said that this initiative of Uttarakhand government will prove as an unique effort to increase the income of farmers. In the first step as a pilot project Mandua will be procured at minimum support price in Almora and Pauri districts.

The grains procured by the government from hilly districts will be distributed through PDS scheme at plane districts like Haridwar, Udham Singh Nagar and plain regions of Dehradun and Nainital districts. To promote the consumption of millets, government is also providing Mandua under Antyoday scheme on each and every ration card.

Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami thanked Prime Minister Narendra Modi and union government for fixing the minimum support price for millets procurement. Chief Minister said that with the permission from central government to purchase 0.096 lakh metric ton Mandua, the farmers of state are also going to be benefited.

MILLETS ARE TRADITIONAL FOOD FOR UTTARAKHANDI

The cultivation of millets in Uttarakhand is said to be old than wheat cultivation. There was a time when Mandua played very important role in

